

point in inheriting someone else's problems. Her payments were still affordable, though she had very little spendable income after all the bills were paid. She quickly found herself \$15,000 dollars in debt.

One of Penny's friends at her new job was Suzanne Duncan, who was about the same age. Suzanne was enthusiastic about a financial seminar she'd heard about, and invited Penny to come to a free introductory session. The speaker was Thom Handleman, and he repeated a catchy if corny slogan about handling your money instead of the other way around. He was a mesmerizing and motivating speaker, and Penny began to take notes, but soon contented herself with listening. She was enamored with his ideas on how to make her money work for her rather than feel enslaved by the constant cycle of need-want-charge-worry.

When she got home, she tried to remember all Thom Handleman had taught, but could only remember her enthusiasm and not what she had been so enthused about. So she signed up for his day-long seminar, which was only five hundred dollars and included a boxed lunch, a DVD of the session she was about to attend, an excerpt from one of his bestselling books, a binder filled with "Handle Your Money!" resources and products, and seven hours in the presence of the financial expert.

After the seminar, Penny didn't feel she was ready to take Handleman's advice on investing in real estate, but she liked his idea of purchasing silver bullion. He had spent an entire hour of the morning session raving about the future of silver—how it had multiple industrial uses because of its malleability and ductility (she reread that part in the resource section several times), and also how it was being used more and more in hospital burn units to prevent bacterial infections. She read that many wound care products incorporate a layer of fabric that contains silver. Handleman pointed out that anyone with a social conscience should want to invest in such a commodity.

So Penny took out a cash advance of \$5,000 on a credit card and purchased silver bullion. She was excited about it when it was delivered and kept it in her safe box at the bank. She was not clear